

Chapter 137-2

Liang Shi, who had never attended university, compared to someone who was fluent in seven languages and held a master's degree from a prestigious overseas university—it was like the difference between mud and clouds.¹

The reason she came to see Chen Liuying today was to figure out whether Chen Liuying had developed tremendous hatred toward her because of the series of things she had done and thus wanted to do this, or whether it was due to the force majeure of the original book that led her to kidnap Xu Qingzhu and stubbornly want to gouge out her glands?

From how things looked now, the latter seemed more likely.

And in order to fight against Chen Liuying, this force majeure, she had been slashed by a knife across her collarbone and arm. Although it wasn't as painful as having her glands gouged out, she had still paid a price.

Moreover, she had also been transported back to her original world for half a month.

All signs indicated that if she wanted to bring change to this world, she would inevitably have to pay a price.

Just like the balance mechanism the System had mentioned before.

Her appearance brought changes to the original world, so she had to bear the corresponding consequences.

These consequences would definitely be negative.

Liang Shi was very unhappy about this realization.

But there was nothing she could do.

Just as she was lost in thought, a strange mechanical sound suddenly rang out in her mind.

Thank goodness, at least there was no longer that electric current sound like a drill buzzing in her head.

The System returned once again: 【Ding dong! Congratulations, Host, on completing all main quests and side quests in the alternate world. The capture target's favorability toward you has already maxed out. You can now continue developing along the storyline!】

【Currently, all passages between dimensional worlds have been closed and are undergoing repairs. Rest assured, the current Little Tong is no longer the Little Tong that used to have bugs! After this upgrade and modification, Little Tong now possesses the universe's latest chip, containing knowledge from tens of millions of dimensional worlds, and can provide you with comprehensive services.】

【PS: Although your main quest has been completed, because you haven't finished the side quest you selected yourself, Little Tong will continue to accompany you in your growth until you choose to close the connection with Little Tong.】

After the System finished its long string of announcements, Liang Shi directly asked: "When you say continue developing along the storyline, are you telling me to leave Xu Qingzhu and make room for the Alpha from the original book?"

Liang Shi asked very seriously, with a hint of worry, terrified that the System would say yes.

But the System fell silent.

It remained silent for so long that Liang Shi thought it had disappeared.

Yet it abruptly appeared again.

System: 【The current storyline has already become chaotic. All the nodes have been crossed and intertwined, and events that didn't appear in the original book have occurred, so the situation is currently unknown.】

And in order to give Liang Shi a more intuitive understanding, the System generously transmitted the complete subsequent storyline of the original book to her.

Liang Shi: "....."

What the hell.

It was enough to make her want to curse.

When Liang Shi had first arrived here, she was completely in the dark, only half-understanding the situation of this world.

All she knew were the major settings and nodes on her own storyline, as well as Xu Qingzhu's subsequent major nodes and settings.

She had struggled for so long knowing nothing, and now the System was finally willing to give her the original book?

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It was so infuriating.

But no matter how angry she was, she still needed to first understand the original book's storyline.

Everything was pretty much the same as what Liang Shi had known before, just with some details filled in.

For example, Xu Qingzhu and Lu Jiayi had met at a banquet. At that time, Xu Qingzhu had been schemed against by a petty person and pushed into the swimming pool. Lu Jiayi was the first to jump in and rescue her.

After that back and forth, the two became acquainted.

Lu Jiayi was from the capital. She had many siblings in her family, and many people coveted the family fortune. As the first-in-line heir of the Lu family, she was surrounded by wolves and tigers—a pure example of "beautiful, strong, and tragic."²

No one could refuse someone who was highly capable yet gentle and gentlemanly, who was "beautiful, strong, and tragic."

Especially when this "beautiful, strong, and tragic" character had so much in common with Xu Qingzhu.

Xu Qingzhu could play the cello; Lu Jiayi could play the piano and violin.

Xu Qingzhu liked Chopin and Monet; Lu Jiayi liked them too.

Xu Qingzhu had read Tagore's poetry anthology over and over again, and reciting it purely in English was no problem. Lu Jiayi could not only discuss Tagore with her but also Shakespeare's plays, Homer's epics, and all sorts of very obscure things.

They didn't just talk about literature and dreams—they could also discuss astronomy and geography, celestial bodies and stars, and gravitational pull.

The book wrote that the most boring thing the two of them ever did together was sitting in the study doing gaokao³ practice questions together.

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1. "The difference between mud and clouds" (雲泥之別) is a Chinese idiom meaning an enormous gap or disparity between two things, like the distance between the sky and the ground. ↵
 2. "Beautiful, strong, and tragic" (美強慘) is a popular Chinese internet slang term describing a character archetype who is physically attractive, highly capable/powerful, but has a tragic backstory or circumstances. It's a beloved trope in romance novels. ↵
 3. Gaokao (高考) is China's national college entrance examination, a highly competitive and important standardized test that largely determines which university a student can attend. ↵